

Assessment - Individual Report:

Report Structure/Submission:

The report should roughly be between 1000 and 3000 words, 7-15 pages. The individual report must be submitted by email to <michael.aristodemou@psychologie.uzh.ch> on the 11th of December 2026, in PDF format.

Task:

Think about a set of (two or more) psychological constructs that change over time and influence each other's evolution. These constructs will define the system that you will study. Your job is to craft a narrative explaining how these constructs change over time and how people might differ in these changes. You can consider factors such as environmental influences, developmental trajectories, stable person-level characteristics, and feedback loops. This narrative does not need to be based in empirical research, but you should be able to reason for it as one possible description of the system you are interested in.

In the report, you will showcase your theoretical system using a combination of verbal descriptions, visualization, simulations, and mathematical notation that you have learned in class. But you should not restrict yourself by technical competence. Feel free to consider and discuss possibilities that you are not able to formally represent or statistically model, highlight these difficulties, and discuss your rationale for proceeding with a simplified form.

The report should demonstrate a solid grasp of course concepts and showcase your ability to consider psychological concepts from a dynamic systems perspective.

Assessment Criteria - Individual Report:

1. **Understanding of Course Content:** Demonstrate understanding of course concepts, mathematical and statistical concepts, and their application to psychological phenomena.
2. **Complexity & Depth:** Explore the phenomenon's complexity by e.g., integrating multiple processes, time scales, and potential influences on system dynamics and or measurement properties. Demonstrate originality and creativity in your analysis and interpretation of the chosen phenomenon. Explore novel approaches or insights that go beyond what was covered in the group presentation.
3. **Critical Thinking:** Engage in critical analysis, considering strengths, alternatives, and limitations.
4. **System Specification and Analysis:** : Specify the system using appropriate methods, such as formal mathematics, descriptive analysis, and R code where applicable. Provide clear and insightful visualizations of the system dynamics.
5. **Clarity and Organization:** Present your analysis in a clear, well-organized manner, with logical flow and appropriate use of headings, subheadings, and visuals.
6. **Use of R Code:** Where applicable, include R code, and ensure code is well-commented and organized.

Assessment - Oral Exam

This assessment is part of the same component as the "Individual Report". The oral exam consists of a 15-20 minute conversation, where you will be asked questions to determine your understanding of the content of your individual report. Therefore, the questions will be restricted to the content of your individual report.

Grading:

The grading scale for the course follows a 1-6 scale, with half grades given. The combination of the "Individual Report" and the "Oral Exam" will make up 100% of the final grade. The assessment criteria listed above serve as the basis for grading the individual report and the oral exam.